

Constant visual searching supports your ability to drive safely. Make sure you are traveling at a speed that supports your ability to search and scan effectively.

Scan to the front

To avoid last-minute braking or the need to turn or swerve suddenly, look ahead for:

- Traffic situations you'll need to steer around and blockages that might hide a pedestrian, bicyclist, or another vehicle.
- Feet, wheels, shadows, and movement in, under, and around parked vehicles.
- What's happening beyond the vehicle in front of you.

Looking ahead allows you to anticipate potential situations and prepares you to stop or change directions if needed.

Scan to the side

- When approaching intersections, pay close attention to vehicles, pedestrians, and cyclists approaching from the left and right.
- Watch for pedestrians and cyclists who might be crossing the road.
- When foliage or other objects obscure your view to the sides, watch for movement to identify potential hazards and people who could be planning to cross the road.
- Before turning, check your side mirrors and do an over-shoulder check for bicyclists or pedestrians who might be alongside you or about to cross the street.

Scan behind

Besides watching traffic in front of and beside you, check traffic behind you. It is essential to look for vehicles and cyclists behind you when you change lanes, turn across a bicycle lane, slow down, back up, or are driving down a long or steep hill.

